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Fields of Concentration:
Primary Fields: Public Economics, Labor Economics
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Qualifying Examinations Completed:
2022 (Oral): Labor Economics, Public Finance
2021 (Written): Microeconomics, Macroeconomics

Dissertation Title: *Essays on the Economics of Transfer Programs*

Committee:
Professor Joseph Altonji (Chair)
Professor Winnie van Dijk
Professor John Eric Humphries
Professor Seth Zimmerman

Education:
Ph.D., Economics, Yale University, 2027 (Expected)
M.Phil., Economics, Yale University, 2023
M.A., Economics, Yale University, 2023
B.S., Mathematics and Economics, Davidson College, *magna cum laude*, 2020

Fellowships, Honors and Awards:
University Dissertation Fellowship, 2025-2026
Kingsley Trust Fellowship, 2025
UC Irvine Student Loan Law Institute Emerging Scholar, 2023
Cowles Foundation Fellowship, 2020-2025
Phi Beta Kappa, Davidson College, 2020
C. Louise Nelson Scholar, Davidson College, 2020
A.K. Phifer Award for Excellence in Economics, Davidson College, 2020
William G. McGavock Award for Excellence in Mathematics, Davidson College, 2020

Duncan Scholar, Davidson College, 2016-2020

Teaching Experience:

Fall 2022, Fall 2024, and Fall 2026, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Cormac O'Dea, Introductory Microeconomics, Yale College

Fall 2023, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Steven Berry, Introductory Microeconomics, Yale College

Spring 2023, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Joseph Altonji, Introduction to Data Analysis and Econometrics, Yale College

Spring 2024, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Gerald Jaynes, Urban Inequalities and Educational Inequality, Yale College

Spring 2026, Teaching Assistant to Prof. John Eric Humphries, Introduction to Data Analysis and Econometrics, Yale College

Working Papers:

"The Human Capital Effects of Housing Assistance", October 2026, *Job Market Paper*

"Where Does the Tide Roll? The Causes and Consequences of Out-of-State Enrollment at Public Universities" with Ryan Haygood, October 2026 (under review)

"A Sin Ban, Not a Sin Tax? Consumption and Incidence of SNAP Soda Restrictions" with Katja Seim and Jintaek Song, September 2026, *NBER Working Paper #35739* (under review)

Work In Progress:

"The Demand for Income Share Agreements" with Constantine Yannelis

Seminar and Conference Presentations:

2026: Notre Dame, AEFP Annual Meeting, NBER Public Fall Meeting
2025: EEA Annual Meeting
2024: Moving Beyond Implications (University of Connecticut)
2023: EEA Annual Meeting

Languages:

English (native)

Software:

Expert: R, Python, Stata, SQL
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References:

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Dissertation Abstract

The Human Capital Effects of Housing Assistance [Job Market Paper]

Almost 4 million children in the U.S. live in households that receive housing subsidies, yet we know relatively little about how this assistance affects their future outcomes. I study the long-run effects of these transfers on children's human capital and use them to assess the program's cost-effectiveness. I find that assistance increases high school graduation and college enrollment and reduces felony convictions in early adulthood, even though test scores do not improve in elementary and middle school.

First, I build a new administrative panel linking more than a decade of housing assistance wait list applications in New Haven, Connecticut, to statewide education, labor market, and criminal justice records. These data allow me to follow applicant children from elementary school through college and into early adulthood.

Second, I develop a research design based on lotteries that randomly order applicants on wait lists for housing vouchers and public housing units. These lotteries shift the date a household is selected from a wait list. In two complementary specifications, I use this variation as an instrument to estimate the effects of receiving assistance on outcomes measured during childhood and the effects of cumulative exposure to housing subsidies on later outcomes measured from ages eighteen to twenty-two.

I find that housing assistance effectively eliminates homelessness and housing instability at young ages. These improvements at home are matched by significant improvements in measures of early

childhood development among boys. Using a latent factor model, I find an increase of nearly 0.4 standard deviation in pre-kindergarten developmental skills for boys. Despite this, I find no persistent effects on elementary and middle school test scores for either boys or girls.

Next, I show that high school graduation and college enrollment among compliers increase: each additional year of assistance raises high school graduation and college enrollment by 2 to 3 percentage points. To reconcile this result with the null effect on test scores, I show that housing assistance increases children's school attachment by raising school attendance and reducing chronic absenteeism and rates of within-year school switching. In contrast, I find no evidence that assisted children attend schools with higher test score value added or higher-performing peers or that assistance changes adults' employment or earnings. Beyond the classroom, housing assistance reduces children's likelihood of a felony conviction in early adulthood by more than 70 percent.

Finally, I translate the educational attainment gains into predicted lifetime earnings and combine them with program costs and projected fiscal savings from reduced incarceration to estimate the marginal value of public funds (MVPF) spent on housing assistance. Under a range of calibrated values for applicants' willingness to pay for assistance, I find that housing assistance yields $2 in benefits per net government dollar spent. Housing vouchers yield greater net benefits than public housing because of larger effects on educational attainment. These results show that housing assistance can cost-effectively improve long-run human capital despite not raising test scores or changing school quality, but the effects depend on how the transfers affect consumption. More generally, evaluations that focus on end-of-grade test scores and other short-run outcomes may miss important benefits of social programs.

Where Does the Tide Roll? The Causes and Consequences of Out-of-State Enrollment at Public Universities, with Ryan Haygood

Public flagship universities increasingly use nonresident tuition revenue to offset declining state funding. Nationally, we find that public flagships facing less state support enroll relatively more high-income nonresidents. We then link two decades of University of Alabama (UA) commencement records to admissions office recruitment visits and individual employment histories. These data allow us to document how universities pursue this revenue margin and to measure downstream effects on graduates and state budgets. We show UA boosts high-income out-of-state demand through targeted recruitment visits: in a difference-in-differences design, new visits generate 8 to 10 percent more future UA graduates. We then trace how nonresident enrollment redirects graduates across state labor markets. We use variation in the state-of-origin composition of UA cohorts, with a shift-share instrument built from origin states' out-of-state enrollment rates at other universities. We estimate that every 100 out-of-state students cause 9 to 15 additional in-state students to leave the state after college. These patterns are consistent with peer effects operating through expanded consideration sets and referral networks. The resulting fiscal losses to Alabama exceed the university's nonresident tuition margins. Finally, the out-of-state expansion appears to support in-state degree production. A budget accounting exercise shows that UA's out-of-state enrollment margins are sufficient to cross-subsidize more than half of the in-state cohort, who receive an average annual subsidy of $13,000 per student.

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A Sin Ban, Not a Sin Tax? Consumption and Incidence of SNAP Soda Restrictions, with Katja Seim and Jintaek Song

We study the first statewide restrictions on purchasing sweetened beverages and candy with Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) benefits. Using a multi-retailer receipt panel and a stacked difference-in-differences design based on the staggered implementation of the waivers in 2026, we find that SNAP households' spending on restricted products falls by 11 percent. These declines reflect lower total purchases rather than a shift to other payment methods, and we find little substitution toward nearby product categories. Across beverage purchases, calories and total sugar fall by 8 percent. These responses are not primarily explained by changes in households' budget sets, as retailers barely change shelf prices and observed payment patterns imply that losing SNAP's sales tax exemption raises tax-inclusive prices by only 1 percent nationwide. Policy-induced nutrition signaling and checkout stigma also appear unlikely to account for most of the response. Finally, we show that under nationwide adoption, the waivers would impose about $176 million in additional sales taxes on SNAP participants, 13 percent of their payments under excise taxes calibrated to produce the same purchase reductions. After accounting for the nutrition-related corrective benefits of the decline in soda and candy consumption, a back-of-the-envelope calculation suggests that the waivers yield annual welfare gains of around $1.1 billion.